

Scapegoats and Conspirators in the Chronicles of Jean Froissart and Jean le Bel

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Ever since the rediscovery of a manuscript of Jean le Bel's *Vrayes Chroniques* in the mid-nineteenth century, scholars have acknowledged that much of Book One of Jean Froissart's *Chroniques* derives from le Bel's work.¹ Indeed, Froissart admits his indebtedness to the canon of Liège at the very beginning of the *Chroniques*.² For this reason, many modern readers, more interested in discussing the historical cause and effect of the *events* in both chronicles than the narrative relationships between them, acknowledge Froissart's indebtedness to le Bel and then move on to historical analysis of one or the other work. To take only the more prominent examples, it has been noted that Froissart "borrows from" le Bel;³ that le Bel is a "primary source" for Froissart;⁴ that Froissart had a "slavish dependence" upon le Bel;⁵ that Froissart copied "verbatim"⁶ or, more guardedly, "almost verbatim";⁷ and that Froissart copied "virtually word for word"⁸ what was in le Bel's *Vrayes Chroniques*. In all of the modern scholarship on either of these chronicles, there is no systematic comparison of one to the other; this critical gap seems to stem, at least in part, from the assumptions underlying the above mentioned language of "verbatim duplication."

However, the two chronicles are not, in fact, identical. A few scholars have acknowledged that there are differences of content, and their work demonstrates how difficult it can be to explain the changes that Froissart effected in his treatment of le Bel's history. For example, Nicole Chareyron has discussed Froissart's departure from le Bel's account of the rape of the countess of Salisbury by Edward III. She argues that le Bel was following continental sources in calling the act a "*viol*," while Froissart's closer connection with Edward's court led him to refer to the act as a "courtly affair."⁹ Monica McAlpine, in looking at the chroniclers' different accounts of the "execution" of the six burghers of Calais, saw "a process in which a story was given a progressively more literary and romantic character" in Froissart.¹⁰ This assertion agrees well with the scholarly commonplace that Froissart was a propagandist for the aristocracy, insofar as removing the often uncomfortable paradoxes of chivalric practice led him from history to "romance." However, McAlpine has little to say on the literary quality of le Bel's work — a quality that Chareyron has made a good case for¹¹ — and her argument does not often acknowledge that the "romantic character" of Froissart's narrative was part of his historiographical enterprise. For

example, Michel Zink has argued that Froissart's *Chroniques* should not be read as "romance" but as a tragedy that served to uncover, in its own way, historical cause and effect, saying that "cette méditation porterait sur la mort des rois et les jeux du destin."¹² George Diller, meanwhile, has argued convincingly that in each of the three (plus) revisions of Book One, Froissart moved further from le Bel in *both* historical content and literary form — regardless of the genre one wants to assign to the work.¹³ Finally, J.J.N. Palmer has argued against Diller's claim that the "A" manuscripts of Froissart are in fact closer to le Bel than other revisions — Palmer sees more resemblances in the Amiens manuscript — although both Diller and Palmer agree that by the time of the late Rome manuscript, Froissart had made many changes.¹⁴ For all of the different conclusions that these readers arrive at, however, they each take the important step of evaluating both Froissart and le Bel by literary as well as historical criteria.

It is this literary approach that can best reveal the significant changes Froissart made to the narrative structure, diction, and figurative systems of le Bel's *Vrayes Chroniques*, even from the earliest revisions; nowhere can this be better seen than in Marie-Thérèse de Medeiros's analyses of multiple contemporary accounts of the Jacquerie. De Medeiros looked at the figurative meaning of the uprising for both chroniclers — including their depiction of rape, cannibalism, and murder in the uprising — and concluded that Froissart's *Chroniques* were, "une adaptation romanesque de la version de J. le Bel."¹⁵ In de Medeiros's reading, the Jacquerie was an unmitigated disaster for the aristocracy, one that imbued le Bel's narrative with an overall "climat de terreur."¹⁶ For Froissart, meanwhile, the event was a threat to the aristocracy but also became one more opportunity for chivalric exploit: "ce soulèvement, par une série de transformations devient séquence romanesque, occasion de 'remoustrer sa gentillece.'"¹⁷ De Medeiros's excellent observations can usefully be expanded beyond the Jacquerie to take in surrounding events, events which frame the uprising both historically and aesthetically. Paying attention to this "frame" suggests that le Bel's narrative, still caught up in the "terreur" of the catastrophe, seeks out scapegoats for the uprising, specifically in the persons of Etienne Marcel, Charles of Navarre, and Robert le Coq, the Bishop of Laon. The presence of these scapegoats allows le Bel's narrative to make some sense of the otherwise meaningless destruction of the Jacquerie by taking responsibility for the uprising out of the hands of the peasantry — who could not, from le Bel's perspective, have been capable of effecting such historically significant activity — and putting the responsibility for the uprising in the hands of powerful men, albeit men who had succumbed to their all too human cupidity and malice. Conversely, by the time Froissart approached the

same material, he found a disaster that already had acquired meanings, both as the latest sign of God's judgment on human sin, and as an aristocratic parable emphasizing the need to bridle the lower classes. Froissart's narrative changes complicate both of those characterizations of the Jacquerie, by telling a story instead of recounting a systemic breakdown in social order, especially in the nobility's willingness to work through third parties, employ demagoguery, and practice unchivalric treachery.

Table 1 schematizes the major differences between le Bel's and Froissart's account of the events surrounding the Jacquerie.¹⁸ The accounts of the free companies are a good starting point to frame the events of the Jacquerie because the depredations of the companies were so closely related to the destruction brought about by the peasant uprising. De Medeiros herself suggests that there were historical connections between the Jacquerie, the defeat at Poitiers, and the presence of free companies throughout France; she even implies that Froissart was aware of these connections.¹⁹ At the other end of events, the murder of Etienne Marcel provides a very neat conclusion to the Jacquerie in both chronicles, insofar as Marcel was one of le Bel's primary scapegoats and one of Froissart's key symbols of the non-chivalric (maybe even anti-chivalric) bourgeois politics that made the Jacquerie possible.²⁰ Between these two framing events exist major narrative details that occur *exclusively* in le Bel or Froissart — that is to say, details that Froissart either excised from or added to his own chronicle. Two such details are especially revelatory as they pertain to the differing goals of the chroniclers: the activities of le Bel's scapegoats — Charles of Navarre, Etienne Marcel, and Robert le Coq — and the role of Froissart's chivalric heroes in quelling the Jacquerie — Jean de Grailly and Gaston Febus.

In addition to these major revisions, however, there are three key moments which were subtly modified by Froissart, but which taken together further differentiate his narrative from that of le Bel: the descriptions of the *routiers*, Etienne Marcel's confrontation with Charles, the duke of Normandy, and Marcel's subsequent murder. Froissart's revisions — whether major or minor — show him abandoning le Bel's strategy of scapegoating individuals, and turning instead to an etiology of *conspiracy*, one which saw the disaster of the Jacquerie as a symptom of a profound decline of aristocratic and chivalric values.

Table 1. *Major Narrative Differences Between le Bel and Froissart*

Le Bel <i>Vrayes Chroniques</i>	Froissart <i>Chroniques</i>
Accounts are given of Ruffin and Robert Knolles, captains of free companies.	Accounts are given of Ruffin and Robert Knolles, captains of free companies.
<i>A personal history of Robert Knolles is given.</i>	
<i>Two</i> knights of the duke of Normandy are murdered by agents of Etienne Marcel.	<i>Three</i> knights of the duke of Normandy are murdered by agents of Etienne Marcel.
The king of Navarre escapes from prison.	The king of Navarre escapes from prison.
	<i>Aid is given to Navarre by Jean de Piquigny and Guy Kyrec.</i>
Navarre challenges Normandy for the Crown.	Navarre challenges Normandy for the Crown.
	<i>Philippe de Navarre refuses to come to Paris.</i>
<i>Officials responsible for tax collection, including Marcel, look to Navarre for aid.</i>	
<i>Marcel asks Navarre about his negotiations with Normandy.</i>	
The Jacquerie begins (Beauvais is not mentioned).	The Jacquerie begins in Beauvais.
<i>Le Bel implicates Marcel and Robert le Coq in the Jacquerie.</i>	
<i>The duke of Normandy searches for the causes and instigators of the uprising.</i>	
	<i>King of Navarre kills numerous Jacques.</i>
	<i>Marcel builds a wall around Paris.</i>
<i>An expanded account is given of how some men of Paris travel to Meaux.</i>	
The count of Foix and the Captal de Buch return from Prussia.	The count of Foix and the Captal de Buch return from Prussia.
	<i>An expanded account is given of the suppression of the Jacquerie by the count of Foix and the Captal.</i>
<i>News from Meaux reaches Paris; Marcel is further implicated.</i>	
Normandy besieges Paris.	Normandy besieges Paris.

	<i>An expanded account is given of negotiations between Normandy and Navarre.</i>
Marcel and Navarre meet in secret.	Marcel and Navarre meet in secret.
	<i>English soldiers are imprisoned in Paris.</i>
	<i>The released English soldiers slaughter French townspeople.</i>
Marcel is murdered.	Marcel is murdered.

Major Revisions: Conspirators and Knights

The first major departure that Froissart makes from le Bel's narrative is in his account of Charles of Navarre's designs on the throne of the imprisoned Jean II. Froissart's account creates an agoraphobic sense of threat by taking the reader out of the essentially omniscient perspective of historical observation and into the narrative present. Both chroniclers report that after Navarre came to Paris, he delivered a speech "moult bellement et moult sagement" [most beautifully and wisely] about why *he* deserved the crown of France more than the Dauphin and — presumably — more than Jean: the first time that sentiment is uttered in either chronicle.²¹ Froissart alone adds that the Dauphin — Charles, duke of Normandy — had to sit and listen quietly, knowing that to say anything would put his life in even greater danger than it had been during his earlier confrontation with Marcel.²² That added detail puts the reader into the "point of view" of the Dauphin — and very clearly not into the perspective of Navarre's audience, the citizens of Paris. Indeed, Froissart makes one more addition in which he relates darkly, in this last moment before his account of the Jacquerie, that Navarre's brother Philippe would not take part in his brother's coup because "en communauté n'avoit nul certain arrest, fors pour tout honnir" [in commonalties there was neither dependence nor union, except in the destruction of everything good].²³ Both "arrest" and "honnir" sit alongside the silent Normandy in Froissart's narrative: through his demagoguery, Navarre has suppressed Normandy's political influence as well as the social values of "union" and "honor," and in so doing he has laid the groundwork for the disaster which would follow.

Froissart's emphasis on systemic decline and nameless conspiracy is also borne out in the way he partially exonerates men who serve as le Bel's villains. Le Bel, with some qualifications, is explicit about the collusion between Marcel, Navarre, and le Coq, going so far as to imply that he has privileged knowledge of their treachery:

Aucuns souspechonnoient l'evesque de Laon qui estoit et fut tousjours malicieux, et sur le prevost des marchans pour tant qu'ilz estoient d'une secte, et d'ung acord, et du conseil du roy de Navarre. Je ne sçay s'ilz en furent coupables, mais je m'en tairay à tant et parleray du remede que Dieux y envoya.²⁴

[Some suspected the Bishop of Laon, who had always been treacherous; and as for the provost of merchants, they were in league together, and of one accord, and in connivance with the king of Navarre. I do not know if they were guilty of it, but I will not speak of it further and will speak of the remedy which God sent for it.]

The above passage illustrates a stylistic difference between le Bel and Froissart that has been observed by Nicole Chareyron: le Bel's stated desire, in his introduction, to report "la vérité" causes his narrative to have an occasional gap or silence — "*vide*" is Chareyron's word — while Froissart's desire to "enrich" the narrative with cause and effect relationships leads his chronicle to fill in vacuums with authorial speculation.²⁵ Although le Bel's *aporia* in the above quote could be seen as politically savvy, his silence nevertheless indicts the three men for the role they had to play in weakening the monarchy and setting the stage for the Jacquerie. Le Bel's narrative seems to be informed by an ethic in which murder and betrayal are always wrong, and his chronicle makes a concession to aristocratic power only by remaining silent. As will be seen shortly, Froissart's narrative employs a more pragmatic, more morally ambiguous approach to the aristocratic use of violence.

In another passage which Froissart omitted, le Bel reflects upon the motivations of Marcel and Navarre as they seek to undermine an accord reached with the duke of Normandy:

Mais le prevost des marchans, et ceulx qui levoient les maletottes et les droitures du roy queroient toudis voye de delay, et occasions diverses par quoy France ne fut oncques sans descord. Ainsy demoura celle paix à faire jusques au moys de may mil CCCLVIII, qu'elle fut acordée ainsy que vous avez ouy cy devant. Si le brisoient, et queroient voyes d'empeschement le prevost des marchands et ses compaignons, et ne vouldissent pas que le roy retornast, affin qu'ilz ne rendissent compte et fussent deposez de leurs offices. Aussy ne le vouldist pas le roy de Navarre, car il doubtoit trop la revenue du roy.²⁶

[But the provost of merchants, and those who paid to collect the king's taxes, continually sought ways to delay, and various

expedients so that France was never without strife. Thus peace remained to be made until the month of May, 1358, when it was made as you have previously heard. Then the provost of merchants and his accomplices sought ways to oppose it, for they did not want the king to return, so that they might not have to give account of themselves and be deposed of their offices. The king of Navarre did not wish this either, since he greatly feared the king's return.]

According to le Bel, Marcel and Navarre both knowingly wanted “discord” because it served their political agendas: usurpation for Navarre, freedom from monarchical control for Marcel. David Mark Bessen has demonstrated how most of the major historical accounts of the Jacquerie report that Marcel's urban revolt against the crown were “tolerant of” the Jacquerie as long as it was in their best interests.²⁷ Le Bel dramatizes their tolerance in his chronicle, particularly in the moment just cited, and in so doing he pins the blame for the Jacquerie on the intemperate ambition of a few corrupt individuals.

Froissart, by comparison, recounts how that same Charles of Navarre rode out against the Jacques, restoring order — and justifying his claim to the throne — where the Dauphin could not.²⁸ Froissart even partially, though grudgingly, exonerates Navarre's main accomplice, Etienne Marcel, by admitting that Marcel helped to strengthen the defenses of Paris, an act which Froissart says “fu li plus grans biens que onques li prevos des marchans fesist en toute sa vie” [was an act of greater utility than any provost of merchants had ever done before].²⁹ However, this shift in tone towards Marcel is more than a disagreement with le Bel about the provost's role in events. After all, Froissart never says that Paris needed Marcel's walls to defend against the Jacquerie; instead he claims that they were required due to threats that came “trop de fois, et par plusieurs actions” [several times by the different factions].³⁰ Once again, we can discern a pervasive, unidentified threat instead of a specific one. Unlike le Bel, Froissart was not interested in laying the blame for the Jacquerie on a handful of men, because he saw the uprising as a symptom of two social “illnesses” besetting France: the ascendancy of the urban middle class, and the abandonment by the aristocracy of the chivalric values of honor and prowess.

For Froissart, these are systemic problems that cannot have localized, individual causes. Even so, time and again Froissart demonstrates how the remedies for these problems lie in the acts of heroic individuals. Such is the case when he makes various additions to le Bel's account of how Gaston Febus, the count of Foix, and Jean de Grailly, the Captal de Buch, returned from crusade in Prussia just in time to suppress the Jacquerie in the city of

Meaux. Le Bel certainly describes Gaston Febus's role in restraining and killing the Jacques, but he does not mention the count's return from crusade, nor the role of Jean de Grailly. Indeed, le Bel quickly dispenses with the Jacques in his narrative, both literally and figuratively. In a passage which Diane Tyson singles out as an example of le Bel's economy of phrase,³¹ the chronicler says that:

Aucuns coururent avant et commencerent à lanchier, mais ce ne fut pas longuement, car on ne pourroit si tost dire ung *Ave Maria* qu'ilz reculerent arriere et se mirent à fuir si durement que l'ung cheioit parmi l'autre, et ces gens d'armes issirent hors sur eulx et les tuoient comme pourceaulx les ungs sur les autres.³²

[Some men-at-arms ran before the main party and began striking, but this did not last for long, because one could not have said an entire *Ave Maria* before the Jacques retreated to the back and took themselves to flight so vigorously that they tripped over one another. And the men-at-arms ran around these Jacques and killed them like swine, one after another.]

De Medeiros argues that the image of hunting is here meant to downplay the "boucheerie" of the nobility, to distinguish that butchery from the bestial (and as she points out, often cannibalistic) behavior of the Jacques.³³ However, because le Bel was temporally closer to the event than Froissart, the former would have had no need to hide the brutality of Febus's actions; instead, he reemphasized to his readers how lopsided the Jacquerie was — once the anomalous "inversion" of reality had passed and once individual heroics could undo individual treachery. The suppression of the Jacques need take up only a small amount of narrative space, because the inherent superiority of the aristocracy is one of the social assumptions that is made in his chronicle.

Conversely, Froissart draws out his account of the massacre, gleanings maximum dramatic potential from the exploits of de Grailly and Febus. De Grailly, an ally of the English, had already established himself as one of Froissart's model knights: a man from a moderate seigneurial background, but one who was both clever and vigorous in battle. Febus, whose allegiances lay with the Dauphin, cuts a complex figure in Froissart, but above all he was known for maintaining a rich and powerful court at Orthez, and for practicing the chivalric virtue of *largesse*; Froissart illustrated that aspect of the count in the *Voyage à Bearn* section of his own chronicle.³⁴ McAlpine reminds us that the collaboration of an English ally with one of the French peers was only to be expected in Froissart, where "military, political, and

other differences disappear into the common membership of all the chivalric community.”³⁵ Froissart’s conspiratorial narrative had set some members of that community against one another, but here the *confrérie* of knights becomes a sleeping giant aroused by the common threat of the Jacques.

The power of that *confrérie* is evoked through the imagery which Froissart uses to describe the arrival of the count of Foix and the Captal in Meaux, imagery which mimics the poetic images of *chevalerie* that are to be seen in the romances and *chansons de gestes*. The count and the Captal heard that only the duke of Orléans stood between the Jacques and a host of noblewomen in distress. Along with the duke of Meaux, they:

vinrent à le porte dou marchié et le fissent ouvrir toute arrière;
et puis se misent au devant de ces villains noirs et petis et mal
armés, et le banière le conte de Foix et ceste dou duch
d’Orliens et le pennon le captal et les glaves et les espées en
leurs mains, et bien apparillies d’yaus deffendre et de garder le
marciét.

Quant ces meschans gens les veirent ensi ordonnés,
comment que il n’estoient point grant fuison encontre eulz, si ne
furent mies si foursené que devant. Mès se commencierent li
premier à reculer. . . .³⁶

[advanced to the gate of the market-place, which they had
opened, and marching under the banners of the earl of Foix and
duke of Orléans, and the pennon of the captal of Buch, (and
with spears and swords in their hands, they) posted themselves
in front of this peasantry, who were (black and small, and)
badly armed.

When these banditti perceived such a troop of gentlemen, so
well equipped, sally forth to guard the market-place, the fore-
most of them began to fall back. . . .]³⁷

Froissart imbues this moment with almost Manichean symbolism: heraldry alone, backed up by true *proesce*, is enough to combat the “dark and small” peasants. The fact that the Captal and the count of Foix were nominally on opposite sides of the French-English “contention” highlights the fact that Froissart structures the Jacquerie as a challenge to the entire (i.e., “global”) nobility, and not just a misfortune brought about by competition for political power in the absence of the *French* monarch. At the same time, however, the Jacquerie is not a real challenge for Froissart; instead, it is characterized by the chaos and shame of the peasantry, and the licit authority and violence of the aristocracy.

Minor Revisions: "Routiers" and Murderers

If the additions and omissions in the stories of Navarre, Febus, and Grailly are the most obvious differences between the two narratives, much more subtle differences of diction and image — seen especially in the accounts of the *routiers* and Etienne Marcel's assault on the duke of Normandy (see Table 1) — also support the idea that le Bel was looking for a more precise locus of blame for the Jacquerie, Froissart for a more systemic one. Froissart follows le Bel by describing two groups of *routiers*, one headed by a Welshman named Ruffin, the other headed by Sir Robert Knolles and composed of "une plus grande compagnie de pilleurs et de robeurs englès et navarois" [a still greater number of English and Navarrais, plunderers, and robbers].³⁸ Froissart is less critical than le Bel of the activities of this second company and leaves out many of the deleterious effects of their campaigns. His charity is significant, since the only difference between the two groups is that the men-at-arms of the first company dub their (non-aristocratic) leader Ruffin as a "knight" through their own authority, while the second company is led by a "gentleman-adventurer" of some renown, Sir Robert Knolles. Kenneth McRobbie has identified Sir Robert Knolles as one of the best examples of Froissart's love of low-born or disadvantaged knights who perform well on the battlefield and are rewarded appropriately in courtly society,³⁹ a love which perhaps explains the chronicler's less critical account of Knolles's band of plunderers.

If that is the case, however, it is curious that Froissart omits an entire passage about the life history of Knolles included in Le Bel:

Et sachiez que cil Robert Canolle dont je vous ay parlé, estoit parmentier de draps, quant ces guerres commencherent; sy devint brigand et soldoyer à pyé, et estoit Alemand; si se porta si bien et par fortune et par soubtilété, et conquesta tant de chasteaulx en Santonge, en Poytou et en Bretagne par emblée et aultrement, qu'il eut bien de revenue XL^M escus, et bien C^M en meuble, ainsy que on disoit; et toudis conqueroit et tenoit soldoiers à ses gages. Et bien disoit qu'il ne guerrioit pas pour le roy d'Angleterre, mais pour luy mesmes et en son nom, et bien paioit ses souldoiers et de ses propres deniers.⁴⁰

[And understand (know) that this Robert Canolle of whom I have spoken was a tailor when these wars began. He then became a brigand and mercenary, and was German; he conducted himself well both by luck and by craftiness and conquered numerous castles in Saintonge, Poitou, and Brittany by theft and other means so that it was said that he had 40,000

écus in coin and 100,000 in goods; he constantly pillaged and kept mercenaries in his employ. And he used to say that he was not fighting for the king of England, but for himself and in his name, and he paid his mercenaries well with his own money.]

Le Bel is interested in Knolles's rise from low origins, but only as an explanation for the *routier's* willingness to participate in banditry: the two words that are most damning, after all, are "brigand and foot-soldier." Since Knolles is not *gentile* from birth, he must have some internal flaw; this tends to confirm Chareyron's assertion that le Bel wanted to see divine justice brought against the *routiers*, as well as support Tyson's assertion that the activities of the *routiers* were "empty manifestations" of chivalry.⁴¹

For Froissart, however, there were no "empty manifestations" of chivalry — an act was either ethically and socially meaningful or it was unchivalric. Chivalry is not a code or class of people in the *Chroniques* as much as it is a state of being — a kind of secular grace that has the power to redeem the most violent sinners.⁴² Froissart's narrative strives to forgive men who engage in indiscretions like plundering the countryside, as long as those men otherwise display the chivalric virtues of *proesce* and *largesse*. Robert Knolles displays both when Froissart relates that Knolles, "tenoit grant fuison de saudoiiers à ses gages, et les paioit si bien que cescuns le sievoient volentiers" [kept a great many soldiers in his pay; and, being very liberal, he was cheerfully followed and obeyed].⁴³ This description is noticeably different from le Bel's narrative, which mentions only the pay. Froissart's addition characteristically adds a psychological component to the chivalric understanding of violent men: Knolles's payment of the men was not a formality but a clear indication to Froissart's aristocratic readers that Knolles knew how to motivate soldiers to risk their lives. That knowledge is significant in Froissart's chronicle because it was something he would have shared with exemplary knights like Jean de Grailly and Gaston Febus. Fourteenth- and fifteenth-century manuals of chivalry, and their commentaries, made frequent reference to hierarchies of chivalric virtues, hierarchies that were characterized by how *relative* they were: there was no correct way of being a knight, just a continuum of better and worse ways to *practice* chivalry.⁴⁴ Writing with a sympathetic pen, Froissart could criticize a *routier* like Knolles while still *comparing* him favorably to a man like Ruffin. Moreover, we see here one of the more obvious consequences of Froissart's creation of conspiratorial systems: unlike le Bel, who attributes specific blame for the breakdown of social order on individuals like Knolles, Froissart's narrative diffuses blame for that breakdown and deflects it from groups like the free companies who were associated with his beloved *faits d'armes*.

Froissart's devotion to chivalric culture leads him to introduce many small but significant changes to le Bel's account of a central moment in the lead-up to the Jacquerie: the murder of two of the Dauphin's knights by supporters of Etienne Marcel, the provost of Paris. The confrontation grew out of Charles's own political weakness and the desire of the Parisians for political enfranchisement, but from the beginning Froissart uses an aside to shift blame for this breakdown of order onto yet another nameless conspiracy: "Or vous di que li noble dou royaume de France et li prelat de sainte Eglise se commencièrent à taner de l'emprise et ordenance des trois estas. Si en laissoient le prevost des marchans couvenir et aucuns des bourgeois de Paris" [I must here inform you, that the nobles and prelates of the realm and church began to be weary of the government and regulations of the three estates; they therefore permitted the provost of the merchants to Paris to summon some of the citizens.]⁴⁵ The support Marcel received from unnamed "nobles" and "prelates" is, perhaps, the *fundamental* sickness of the body politic, of which the free companies and Jacques were the symptoms. The problem lay not in the disunity within the nobility that this action made manifest: after all, part of aristocratic culture was predicated on the fact there would be competition for power. Instead, the very need for mediation by a man like Etienne Marcel is a problem, insofar as his power derives not from hierarchical, feudal authority, but from the gritty world of politics and popular support — Philippe of Navarre's "communauté" reconfigured here as the "bourgeois."

Froissart's account of the confrontation between Charles of Normandy and the supporters of Etienne Marcel adds many details to le Bel's version, details that highlight the weakening, collapse, and inversion of the social hierarchy. The "nobles and prelates" began that process of inversion by abrogating their authority when they sent a merchant to do their work for them. Only confusion could result from that dispersal of political power: "li prevos des marchans assambla ossi grant fuison de commugnes de Paris qui estoient de sa secte et de son acord; et portoient cil caperons tous sannables, afin que mieulz se recogneussent" [the provost of the merchants collected also a great number of the common people of Paris who were devoted to him, all wearing caps similar to his own, that they might know each other].⁴⁶ Jean le Bel uses the confrontation between Marcel's followers and the duke of Normandy to draw one more connection between his villain — Marcel — and the Jacquerie. Froissart, however, does not make an historical assertion at this moment as much as a literary gesture: all members of society in his narrative lack *recogneissance*: recognition of their own place in society, recognition of their friends and enemies, recognition of the dangerous epoch in which they were living. The Parisians needed

their “caperons” precisely because in Paris, at this moment, one could not tell who is on whose side, nor who possesses real power.

In terms of Froissart’s reception of le Bel, the confrontation between Charles of Normandy and the Parisians is important because both versions of the event are so similar that they appear to support the aforementioned notion that Froissart “slavishly” copied le Bel.⁴⁷ However, setting both narrative moments side by side reveals that they are not identical:

Je ne sçai pour quoi ne comment ce fu, mès les parolles
monteplièrent tant et si hault que là endroit furent, en le
presence dou duch de Normendie, occis trois des plus grans de
son conseil, si priès de li que sa robe en fut ensanglantée. Et en
fu il meismes en grant peril, mès on li donna uns des caperons à
porter.⁴⁸

[I cannot pretend to say how it happened, but words in-
creased so much and with such warmth, that at last three of
the principal counsellors of the duke were slain, and so near to
him that their blood flew over his robe: he himself was in very
great danger, but they had put one of their caps on his
head.]⁴⁹

Compare le Bel:

Je ne sçay comment, ne par qui ce fut, mais les parolles mont-
erent sy hault que deux de son conseil furent tuez emprez luy,
tant que sa robe en fut ensanglantée, et par aventure y eust il
esté tué, si on ne l’eust mis hors la presse.⁵⁰

[I do not know how this was done, nor by whom, but their
words rose to such a pitch that two of Normandy’s party were
killed near him, so that his robe became bloodied; and there
perchance he would have been killed, if he had not been
removed from the mob.]

Froissart’s most noticeable change immediately heightens the severity of the violence: he adds one murder victim. Froissart also inserts “monteplièrent,” increased or multiplied, for “monterent,” climbed; in fact he abstracts le Bel’s vertical metaphor by asserting that the language — *parolles* — of the encounter not only “climbed so high (*sy hault*)” but also “increased so much (*tant*).” Referring to the location of the murders, Froissart uses the phrases “en le presence” and “si prieès” where le Bel succinctly says “emprez.” Finally, Froissart adds the detail of someone (the Marcel’s men? the Dauphin’s own men?) placing a guild cap on the Dauphin’s head in order to save him, whereas le Bel’s narrative briefly reports that he is whisked

away to safety. All of Froissart's changes consistently emphasize the rapid escalation of the encounter and the physical nearness of the killings to the body of the Dauphin.

Diller's argument for Froissart's oral dictation of the *Chroniques* is a beneficial idea here, even though Diller never directly discusses Book One.⁵¹ One might imagine that Froissart had access to a copy of le Bel, read that copy enough to get the "gist" of it, but did not consult the copy regularly during the composition of his own work. Even if Froissart did have a copy of le Bel to consult, as a *narrative* le Bel's *Vrayes Chroniques* was too long to be "available" to Froissart's conscious mind, to borrow a term from Wolfgang Iser. Thus, Froissart (along with every subsequent reader of le Bel) had to engage in a process that Iser calls "consistency-building": a process that readers must practice when confronted with "large-scale texts such as novels or epics" the meaning of which "cannot be continually 'present' to the reader with an identical degree of intensity."⁵² By looking both at Froissart's retention of collocations and tropes and at his insertion of descriptive terms like "ensanglantée," we can speculate as to what historiographical concepts, narrative moments, and even images contributed to Froissart's "gestalt" construction of le Bel's chronicle.⁵³ De Medeiros implies such a process of "consistency-building" when she discusses Froissart's use of the collocation *sans chief*, "without a leader": a collocation which is carried over from le Bel's account of the Jacquerie into Froissart's because the political vacuum those words imply was the fundamental perversity of the Jacquerie for both chroniclers.⁵⁴ Likewise, Froissart magnifies le Bel's emphasis on the proximity of the murders to the person of Normandy for the same reason that he exactly replicates the word "ensanglantée," which is a participle whose evocative power is not readily translated into English.⁵⁵ As a magnate and as a knight, Normandy is liable to be spattered with blood — perhaps even his own blood — as one might imagine his father had been two years earlier at the battle of Poitiers. However, blood shed by weapons should never touch Normandy's *robes*, the symbols of his estate at court. The inclusion of the detail in this account of a brief incident of violence thus serves to foreshadow the mass slaughter of nobles, in *their* courtly robes, by the Jacques. Zink has asserted that Froissart modified his conception of the exemplary "good and bad king" in each subsequent redaction of his *Chroniques* until he was able to "escape" from le Bel in his telling of the downfall of Richard II, but such an "anxiety of influence" model for Froissart's reception of le Bel does not describe what is happening in the former's account of the Jacquerie.⁵⁶ As I have asserted, le Bel strongly desired to establish negative exemplars throughout his account: he wanted to lay the blame for the Jacquerie on specific nobles,

like Charles II of Navarre and Robert le Coq, the Bishop of Laon. But Froissart does not “escape” le Bel’s account as much as he eschews le Bel’s scapegoats in order to criticize the secrecy with which the nobility and the Church were conducting business — in a very unchivalric and unpastoral way — in the regions affected by the *routiers* and the Jacquerie.

Froissart extends that criticism relentlessly through his narrative until the death of le Bel’s ultimate villain, Etienne Marcel. Froissart, who, it must be remembered, had earlier complimented the leadership style of Marcel, here establishes the provost as treacherous and unchivalrous, and as the ultimate cause of his own downfall: “Li prevos des marchans de Paris et cil de sa secte avoient entre yaus souvent pluseurs consaulz secrès pour savoir comment il se poroient parmaintenir” [The provost and those of his party held many secret councils, among themselves, to consider in what manner they could best keep their authority].⁵⁷ The “consaulz secrès” held by the ominously vague “yaus” hearken back to the unidentified “nobles” and “prelates” who conspired to confront Normandy about his succession. Compared to these hidden conspiracies, Navarre’s behavior is admirable: Froissart admits that the king of Navarre was *implicated* in the provost’s conspiracies, but after Marcel’s death Philip of Navarre advises his brother to declare war against Normandy, because “il estoit chiés et cause de le trahison que li prevos et si alloïiet” [he (Navarre) had the reputation of being the chief cause of the provost’s treasons].⁵⁸ That open declaration of war cleared the air between Navarre and the duke of Normandy, in that it made their enmity a matter of public record and an occasion for *faits d’armes*.

By comparison, le Bel keeps the conspiratorial activities of his three scapegoats — Marcel, Navarre, and Robert le Coq — in the forefront of his account of Marcel’s murder:

Et estoient souvent ensemble en secret conseil ledit roy et l’evesque de Laon, et le prevost des marchans, et ne sçavoit on qu’ilz conseilloyent si couvertement, ains s’en esmerveilloient les gens, car ilz veoient bien que la paix, laquelle avoit esté traittie, ne venoit point avant; et ne sçavo[en]t comment ce estoit et si le desiroient, car ilx veoient que les Angloys et ceulx qui avoient esté leurs souldoiers les guerrioient et desroboient entour Parys de jour en jour, et tousjours accroissoit leur nombre.⁵⁹

[And the aforementioned king of Navarre and the bishop of Laon were often together in secret counsel with the provost of merchants, and it was not known that they met/took counsel so secretly, thus people were amazed at it for they saw that the peace which had been negotiated was not forthcoming and

they did not know why this was and they wanted it, for they saw that the English, and those who had been their mercenaries, made war on them and plundered Paris daily; and their number kept on growing.]

Le Coq and Navarre have now joined Marcel's "secret councils," and all three are trying to figure out how to turn the depredations of the "English" — who are really *routiers* — to their advantage. Le Bel provocatively compares the provost, as Froissart does not, to Jacob Arteveldt who, like Marcel, was a third party tool in the earlier struggle between Edward III and Normandy's grandfather Philip.⁶⁰ But le Bel does not emphasize Arteveldt's role as a pawn of Edward — after all, that would reflect poorly on le Bel's hero — but rather highlights Arteveldt's misdeeds as an upstart trying to upset the social order. That inversion of social hierarchy is the great crime of not only Marcel, but also the bishop of Laon and the king of Navarre, for even members of the First and Second Estates can betray their own kind. Such culpability is rarely seen in Froissart's chronicle, where, as I argued earlier, the grace bestowed by chivalric exploit shields the nobility from accusations of criminality: in Froissart, only the provost of merchants can thus be punished for his mistake of judgment — Navarre's character is rehabilitated in Froissart, and le Coq is not mentioned at all.

When it comes to the punishment of Marcel, both writers invoke divine intervention in the foiling of Marcel's plot to surrender Paris to the English; however, they do so in very different contexts. Le Bel's prose becomes almost Biblical in its allusion to prophetic revelation:

Au derrain, Dieu ne voulut plus tel orgueil regner, si inspira et esveilla aucuns des bourgoys et les mist en voye de sous-pechon de trahison; et entre les aultres en y eut ung que on appelloit Jehan Mailhart, qui se mist en plus vray advis que les aultres.⁶¹

[At last, God did not want such pride to rule any longer, so he inspired some of the burghers and awoke their suspicions of treason; and among them was one who was called Jean de Mailhart, who had a clearer understanding than the others.]

"Orgueil regner": it was not merely the pride of Marcel that had to be corrected, but also that of Navarre and le Coq. Conversely, in Froissart the role of the divine vision is retained, but it is relegated to a parenthetical insertion:

Celle propre nuit que ce devoit avenir, espira et esvilla Diex aucuns bourgeois de Paris qui estoient de l'acort et avoient toutdis esté dou duch de Normandie, desquelz Jehans Maillars

et Symons ses frères se faisoient chief. Et furent cil par inspiration divine, ensi le doit on supposer, enfourmé que Paris devoit estre courue et destruite.⁶²

[The night on which this enterprise was to take place, God shewed his mercy to some of the citizens who had always been attached to the duke, that is to say, John Maillart, his brother Symon, and many others, who by divine inspiration (as one may well suppose it) gained information that Paris was to be sacked and destroyed.]⁶³

I do not take the interjection “as one may well suppose it” to denote Froissart’s skepticism about the divine vision. Rather, he is asserting the logical necessity of divine intervention at this moment. Marcel was not alone in holding “secret councils” before, during, and after the Jacquerie, but he was present during many of those councils and therefore, Froissart implies, deserves to die. The men who will carry out the death sentence — men who are “de l’acort” of Normandy, and therefore the licit monarchical power in France — cannot uncover Marcel’s plot through Marcel’s own tools of secrecy and deceit. Instead, they must rely on the same divine support which, for Froissart, undergirds the Church, the monarchy, and the aristocracy.

Conclusion: The Jacquerie

Both chroniclers’ accounts of the Jacquerie are almost identical. But as we have seen, Froissart’s strategic revisions of le Bel’s accounts of the *routiers*, the confrontation between Normandy and Etienne Marcel, and the murder of Marcel changed the meaning of the moments that he retained from le Bel’s narrative by reframing them. Since those three revised accounts bracket the narrative of the Jacquerie in both chronicles, they in turn reframe that narrative in Froissart’s retelling. For example, the Jacques, in an indirect dialogue that neither le Bel nor Froissart would have been privy to, decided that the knights and squires of France “trahissoient le royaume, et que ce seroit grans biens, qui tous les destruiroit” [were a disgrace to it, and that it would be a very meritorious act to destroy them all].⁶⁴ Froissart is understandably close to le Bel here because this affront to the existence of the nobility is historically important — perhaps even epochal — and he wants to get every detail right. In almost every page of their chronicles, le Bel and Froissart reinforce the chivalric ideology that violence *exercised by knights* maintains social order and specifically maintains the hierarchies that prevent society from falling into chaos. If killing knights is a “great good,”

as the above peasant chorus suggests, then the old understanding of how society functions has been turned upside-down, as de Medeiros has demonstrated in her study.⁶⁵ That “inversion” — to use de Medeiros’s word — suggests a logical connection between the words and deeds of the peasants in both accounts, a connection that becomes explicit when the mob went “sans aultre conseil, sans armeures que de baston ferrez et de coustiaulx en la maison du’ung chevalier” [without counsel, without arms except iron rods and knives into the house of a knight].⁶⁶ The peasants are not being impulsive here, charging into the *maison* with their butcher’s tools: because they have already disavowed public order, they are ontologically incapable of taking “conseil.” Neither le Bel nor Froissart offers the possibility of an *alternate* social order, a counter-hegemony if you will; their narratives suggest that anarchy will be the sole outcome if the Jacquerie should go unchecked.

Even as the two chronicles agree on the inherent disorder of the Jacques, Froissart’s narrative stands out because, as we saw in the account of the murder of Normandy’s knights, he depicts an analogous disorder amongst the nobility. In that episode, the members of the nobility could no longer identify either their superiors or their allies because they had resorted to conspiracies rather than warfare, private violence rather than public violence. *Faits d’armes* in Froissart are always accompanied by some formal speech, but as we have seen, Froissart’s conspirators could never speak in public. Likewise, in Froissart’s and le Bel’s accounts of the Jacquerie, there is no formal oratory on the part of the Jacques, but instead inarticulate language, as above, that sounds like hate speech. The rhetorical brutishness of the peasants quickly inhabits the narratives of the chroniclers: “briserrent l’ostel et le tuerent, et sa femme et ses enfans, et puis ardirent l’ostel” [they broke into the house, and killed the knight and his wife and children, and burnt the building to the ground].⁶⁷ The narratives suggest the same indiscretion that was shown by the *routiers*, but the plodding structure and use of asyndetic parataxis in *both* accounts suggest a lack of reason that differentiates the Jacquerie from the free companies.⁶⁸ It is Froissart, however, who has already laid a groundwork for the different gradations of the free companies, while le Bel has grouped them all together. To distinguish them, in turn, from the Jacquerie becomes less onerous in Froissart’s account.

Both le Bel and Froissart write how a full account of the horror of the Jacquerie is beyond good taste: “Je n’oseroie escrire ne raconter les horribles fais et inconvenables que il faisoient as dames” [I dare not write the horrible and inconceivable atrocities they committed on the persons of the ladies].⁶⁹ As Chareyron has already suggested, the claim is for dramatic

effect only:⁷⁰ as if to take up their own dare, both writers immediately continue with the most gruesome vignette in perhaps either chronicle:

entre les aultres deshonnestes faiz, ilz tuerent ung chevalier et le mirent en haste et le rostirent, voyant la dame et les enfans. Aprez ce que X ou XII eurent enforcié la dame, il luy en vou-lurent faire mengier par force, puis ilz le firent morir de male mort.⁷¹

[among their other shameful deeds, they killed a knight, and placed him on a spit, and roasted him before the eyes of his wife and children. After ten or twelve had raped the lady, they made her eat her husband by force, then violently killed her.]

However, even this brutal scene carries different meaning in both chronicles. In le Bel's work, it is a concrete example of the consequences of the abuse of power by unscrupulous leaders. For Froissart's narrative, the worst aspect of the scene is that it is woven into the conspiratorial intrigues of the nobility. Preying upon themselves without reason and without respect of boundaries, the nobility have already caused inappropriate bloodshed. The cannibalism and rape described in the Jacquerie are only different in degree, and not in kind, from the drops of blood on the robes of the Dauphin.

Le Bel's chronicle thus constructs society in such a way that individuals, and the fates of individuals, can have a profound effect on the social order; this is perhaps one of the ways in which le Bel carries on his struggle — first identified by Chareyron — to balance free will and divine predestination in his historiography.⁷² Meanwhile, Froissart's subtle changes broaden the disaster of the Jacquerie, while making that disaster more figuratively powerful. As I have suggested, for all of Froissart's emphasis on the glories of chivalry, his *Chroniques* implicitly assert that all social agents, regardless of their position in class hierarchies, operate within the boundaries of their own power relationships. His narrative effectively used a "passive construction" to show how many of those relationships had *been allowed* to deteriorate and become uncertain, with the effect that cannibalism and "public" rape became possible.

The two chronicles' difference of "voice" reflects the relationship in time between both writers and the events they were describing. Each chronicle was certainly a "histoire de témoignage" as Chareyron has asserted,⁷³ but in "witnessing" the crisis of the Jacquerie, each chronicler sought for an etiology of the event. Le Bel, who was at the peak of his career while the Jacquerie was taking place, was eager to assign blame to specific parties; the "dyablerie" of the Jacquerie was the result of the

singular malice of a few men. Froissart, having the advantage of hindsight, takes le Bel's narrative and places that narrative within a broader historiographical (one might almost say mythological) context, one that asks how the nobility could have let this disaster come to pass; Froissart's ever unspoken implication is that the nobility were all complicit — to greater and lesser degrees — in allowing social order to unravel.

Notes

¹ Michael Jones, "The Breton Civil War," 64–81 (65) in *Froissart: Historian*, ed. J.J.N. Palmer (Woodbridge, Suffolk; Totowa, N.J.: Rowman and Littlefield, 1981). Here I should like to heartily thank the editors for their input in revising this article, and especially Professor Steven M. Taylor for his assistance in rendering the English translations of excerpts from le Bel.

² Jean Froissart, vol. 1, part 2 of *Chroniques*, ed. S. Luce, G. Raynaud, L. Mirot and A. Mirot, Société de l'Histoire de France (Paris: J. Renouard, 1869–), 1–2. Following convention, the work will be referred to hereafter as "SHF."

³ Michel Zink, "La Fin des *Chroniques* de Froissart et le Tragique de la Cour," 79–95 (82) in *The Court and Cultural Diversity: Selected Papers from the Eighth Triennial Congress of the International Courtly Literature Society, The Queen's University of Belfast, 26 July–1 August 1995*, ed. Evelyn Mullally and John Thompson (Cambridge: D.S. Brewer, 1997).

⁴ Philippe Contamine, "Froissart and Scotland," 43–58 (48) in *Scotland and the Low Countries, 1124–1994*, ed. Grant G. Simpson (East Linton: Tuckwell Press, 1996).

⁵ J. van Herwaarden, "The War in the Low Countries," 101–117 (101) in *Froissart: Historian*, ed. J.J.N. Palmer (Woodbridge, Suffolk; Totowa, N.J.: Rowman and Littlefield, 1981).

⁶ J.J.N. Palmer, "Book I (1325–1378) and Its Sources," 7–24 (8) in *Froissart: Historian*.

⁷ Diana Tyson, "Jean le Bel: Portrait of a Chronicler," *Journal of Medieval History* 12 (1986): 315–32 (315).

⁸ Peter F. Ainsworth, *Jean Froissart and the Fabric of History* (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1990), 228.

⁹ Nicole Chareyron, "L'Amour d'Edouard III d'Angleterre pour la Comtesse de Salisbury: Histoire, Conte de Fées ou Tragédie?," *Revue de Littérature Comparée* 70 (1996): 341–56 (344); Nicole Chareyron, "Crimes et Châtiments dans *La Chronique* de Jean le Bel," 107–120 (118) in *La Violence dans le Monde Médiéval* (Aix-en-Provence: CUERMA, 1994).

¹⁰ Monica E. McAlpine, "The Burghers of Calais: Chapters in a History," 231–58 (235) in *Retelling Tales: Essays in Honor of Russel Peck*, ed. Thomas Hahn and Alan Lupack (Woodbridge, Suffolk, UK: D.S. Brewer, 1997).

¹¹ Nicole Chareyron, *Jean le Bel: Le Maître de Froissart, Grand Imagier de La Guerre de Cent Ans* (Brussels: DeBoeck University, 1996), 16.

¹² Zink, "La Fin des *Chroniques*," 79–95 (81).

¹³ George T. Diller, "La Dernière rédaction du premier livre des *Chroniques* de Froissart: Une Étude du Reg. lat. 869," *Le Moyen Age* 76 (1970): 91–125 (91–92).

¹⁴ Palmer, "Book I," 7–24 (8).

¹⁵ Marie-Thérèse de Medeiros, *Jacques et Chroniqueurs: Une étude comparée de récits contemporains relatant la Jacquerie de 1358* (Paris: Éditions Honoré Champion, 1979), 65.

¹⁶ *Ibid.*, 47.

¹⁷ *Ibid.*, 65.

¹⁸ The order of events listed here does not change between the A and B versions of Froissart's first redaction, nor does it change in the Amiens manuscript; the Rome Manuscript ends before the events of 1358. There are quite subtle differences between the A and B versions edited in SHF and the Amiens manuscript, but they do not affect the arguments made here.

¹⁹ De Medeiros, *Jacques et Chroniqueurs*, 21, 52–53.

²⁰ Numerous historians have made the case for connections between the Jacquerie, Etienne Marcel, and Robert le Coq; an excellent review of these assertions can be found in David Mark Bessen, "The Jacquerie: Class War or Co-opted Rebellion?," *Journal of Medieval History* 11 (1985): 43–59 (43–45).

²¹ SHF, 5.98; Jean le Bel, vol. 2 of *Chronique de Jean le Bel*, ed. Jules Viard and Eugène Déprez, Société de l'Histoire de France (Paris: Librairie Renouard, 1905), 253. Referred to hereafter as "Déprez and Viard." Déprez and Viard omit the second "moult" found in SHF. Note that all translations of le Bel are my own. Translations of Froissart are taken from Jean Froissart, *Chronicles of England, France, Spain, and the Adjoining Countries*, ed. and trans. Thomas Johnes, 2 vols. (London: Routledge, 1874); referred to hereafter as "Johnes."

²² See Table 1.

²³ SHF, 5.99; Johnes 1.180.240.

²⁴ Déprez and Viard, 2.258.

²⁵ Chareyron, *Jean le Bel: Le Maître de Froissart*, 57–58.

²⁶ Déprez and Viard, 2.254.

²⁷ Bessen, "Jacquerie," 46.

²⁸ SHF, 5.102.

²⁹ SHF, 5.103; Johnes 1.183.241.

³⁰ *Ibid.*

³¹ Diana B. Tyson, "Jean le Bel, Annalist or Artist?," 217–26 (220) in *Studies in Medieval French Language and Literature Presented to Brian Woledge in Honour of his 80th Birthday*, ed. Sally Burch North (Geneva: Droz, 1988).

³² Déprez and Viard, 2.261–62.

³³ De Medeiros, *Jacques et Chroniqueurs*, 43.

³⁴ See Ainsworth, *Jean Froissart and the Fabric of History*, 304; George T. Diller, “Froissart’s 1389 Journey to Béarn: A Voyage Narration to the Center of the *Chroniques*,” 50–60 in *Froissart Across the Genres*, ed. Donald Maddox and Sara Sturm-Maddox (Gainesville: UP of Florida, 1998), and John Flyer, “Froissart and Chaucer,” 195–218 (202) in *Froissart Across the Genres*.

³⁵ McAlpine, “Burghers of Calais,” 231–58 (236).

³⁶ SHF, 5.105.

³⁷ Johnes, 1.184.242. Note that Johnes’s translation omitted some phrases in the French original, which have been restored here in brackets.

³⁸ SHF, 5.95; Johnes 1.177.238.

³⁹ Kenneth McRobbie, “The Concept of Advancement in the Fourteenth Century in the *Chroniques* of Jean Froissart,” *Canadian Journal of History* 6 (1971): 1–19 (10).

⁴⁰ Déprez and Viard, 2.251.

⁴¹ Chareyron, “Crimes et Châtiments,” 107–120 (117); Tyson, “Portrait,” 329–30.

⁴² For discussions of the lay piety of chivalry, see Maurice Keen, *Chivalry* (New Haven; London: Yale UP, 1984), 51–63; and Richard W. Kaeuper, *Chivalry and Violence in Medieval Europe* (Oxford: Oxford UP, 1999, 2001), 45–57.

⁴³ SHF, 5.95; Johnes 1.177.238.

⁴⁴ For hierarchies of chivalry see Keen, *Chivalry*, 143–61; Kaeuper, *Chivalry and Violence*, 189–98; Richard W. Kaeuper and Elspeth Kennedy, “Charny and Chivalric Reform,” 48–64 (54–64) in *The Book of Chivalry of Geoffroi de Charny: Text, Context, and Translation* (Philadelphia: University of Pennsylvania Press, 1996); and Allen J. Frantzen, *Bloody Good: Chivalry, Sacrifice, and the Great War* (Chicago and London: University of Chicago Press, 2004), 77–95. For chivalry as “practice” rather than “theory,” see Kaeuper, *Chivalry and Violence*, 139.

⁴⁵ SHF, 5.95–96; Johnes, 1.178.239.

⁴⁶ SHF, 5.96; Johnes, 1.178.239.

⁴⁷ See notes 1–8 of this article for examples.

⁴⁸ SHF, 5.96.

⁴⁹ Johnes, 1.178.239.

⁵⁰ Déprez and Viard, 2.252.

⁵¹ George T. Diller, “Froissart: Patrons and Texts,” 145–60 (150) in *Froissart: Historian*.

⁵² Wolfgang Iser, *The Act of Reading: A Theory of Aesthetic Response* (Baltimore and London: Johns Hopkins University Press, 1978), 16.

⁵³ Iser, *Act of Reading*, 120–31.

⁵⁴ De Medeiros, *Jacques et Chroniqueurs*, 30.

⁵⁵ Compare other attempts to render the word in English: Brereton’s “his robe was splashed with blood” in Jean Froissart, *Chronicles*, ed. and trans. Geoffrey Brereton

(Harmondsworth: Penguin Books, 1978), 150; and Lord Berners's "his clothes were all bloody with their blood" in Froissart, *The Chronicles of Froissart*, trans. Lord Berners, John Bouchier, ed. G.C. Macaulay (London: Macmillan and Co., Ltd., 1924), 135.

⁵⁶ See Zink, 83–85 for the "good and bad king"; for "anxiety of influence" see Harold Bloom, *The Anxiety of Influence: A Theory of Poetry* (London and New York: Oxford UP, 1975).

⁵⁷ SHF, 5.115; Johnes, 1.187.245.

⁵⁸ SHF, 5.119; Johnes, 1.188.247.

⁵⁹ Déprez and Viard, 2.265–266.

⁶⁰ Ibid., 266.

⁶¹ Déprez and Viard, 2.266.

⁶² SHF, 5.115.

⁶³ Johnes, 1.187.245–46.

⁶⁴ SHF, 5.99; Johnes, 1.181.240.

⁶⁵ De Medeiros, *Jacques et Chroniqueurs*, 51.

⁶⁶ Déprez and Viard, 2.256.

⁶⁷ Ibid.

⁶⁸ Compare this to the use of parataxis in the *Chanson de Roland* as discussed in: Erich Auerbach, *Mimesis: The Representation of Reality in Western Literature*, trans. Willard R. Trask (Princeton, N.J.: Princeton UP, 1953), 99–121.

⁶⁹ SHF, 5.100; Johnes, 1.181.240.

⁷⁰ Nicole Chareyron, "Crimes et Châtiments," 113.

⁷¹ Déprez and Viard, 2.257.

⁷² Chareyron, *Jean le Bel: Le Maître de Froissart*, 72.

⁷³ Ibid., 7.

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